Yuvaraj Gopalan

Engineering Manager · Technical Program & Delivery Manager · Quality Engineering Leader

Leipzig, Germany · Available immediately · Open to relocation: Germany, Europe, Gulf, India, Singapore, Malaysia

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24+ years in quality engineering

14 direct reports managed

350+ REST APIs validated in CI/CD

7 Agile teams under quality ownership

ABOUT

I help software teams ship products they can trust. Over 24+ years across SAP, cybersecurity SaaS, telecom and IoT my work has moved from hands-on testing to leading people and delivery. I have managed distributed teams (up to 14 direct reports, including vendor resources), covering hiring, one-to-ones, goal setting, performance reviews, performance improvement plans and development plans, run Agile and Kanban delivery, and set quality strategy that holds up in practice, with AI-assisted engineering where it helps.

I am looking for engineering manager, QA test manager, team lead and delivery or program manager roles, with a focus on managing and mentoring teams, setting quality strategy and owning delivery, with technical oversight rather than day-to-day coding. Germany first; open to Europe and the Gulf.

EXPERIENCE

08/2026 – 11/2026

Freelance Project Manager & Test Automation Consultant

Freelance · Salesforce automation for two international clients (India and the UK)

- Managed delivery: planned and scheduled work, tracked effort and progress, and reported status to stakeholders and clients.
- Delivered a Playwright/TypeScript framework (Page Object Model, self-healing) with 345 end-to-end tests, and Python API automation with 40 API tests.
- Built a Python test data framework (NumPy, Pandas, Pydantic) that creates validated records on demand and respects Salesforce validation and duplicate rules.

Playwright · TypeScript · Python · Salesforce · Pandas · Pydantic

07/2025 – 07/2026

Project Manager | Automation Architect

ACL Digital, Bengaluru, India · Cisco Smart Spaces (IoT and location-intelligence platform)

- Owned automation architecture: extended the existing Playwright (Python, Robot Framework) framework with new modules and test suites, and built a new Playwright TypeScript framework with POM for stability and faster execution.
- Created self-healing automation; built Auto-Heal and a Smart Automation Report.
- Set up Jenkins CI/CD validation for the engine, UI and API.
- Built AI-assisted validation across requirements, code, APIs and CI/CD evidence; trained 40 people on internal AI tools (Copilot and Codex).

Playwright · Python · Robot Framework · TypeScript · Codex · Copilot · Sauce Labs · Jenkins

02/2023 – 06/2025

Engineering Manager

Swimlane (SOAR security-automation SaaS), Hyderabad, India

- Led the Technical Integrations team: 14 direct reports (8 engineers, 6 vendor resources) delivering several hundred third-party integrations (connectors) for the Turbine platform, plus the content library, external marketplace and customer-facing solution workflows.
- Full people-management responsibility: hiring (job descriptions, working with recruiting agencies and HR on candidate profiles), goal setting, regular one-to-ones, coaching and development plans; ran performance reviews and performance improvement plans (PIPs), handled compensation discussions and employee separations.
- Customer success: delivered integrations for customer needs, joined customer calls and stakeholder updates, and handled escalations and incidents with Support, Product and Engineering.
- Introduced AI-driven connector development: connector development coverage from 20% to 80% in six months.
- Led automated validation of 350+ REST APIs in CI/CD pipelines; directed the JMeter performance-testing framework for enterprise rollouts.

07/2014 – 02/2023

Senior Quality Specialist (Senior Principal Engineer)

SAP Labs, Bengaluru, India · S/4HANA, SuccessFactors, Fiori/UI5

- Quality accountability for seven Agile Scrum teams (six automation engineers); ~1,380 automated tests covering 1,700 scenarios.
- Automated S/4HANA and Fiori/UI5 tests with Tosca (2 years), Selenium and Cypress; mobile testing on Sauce Labs.
- Triage Manager for four years (SuccessFactors Compensation, Employee Central, Analytics); handled customer escalations.
- QA for a nine-application SAP Fiori suite (Australian Department of Education programme, Daikin Japan).
- Invited SAP d-kom speaker presenting SuccessFactors Reward and Recognition to 118 customers and partners.

02/2010 – 07/2014

Lead Software Engineer

Syniverse Technologies · telecom OSS/BSS

- Led QA for telecom messaging and BSS billing platforms (interconnect billing, settlement, XDR/CDR usage-to-billing validation).
- Functional, database, integration and performance testing with Selenium, TestNG, LoadRunner and JMeter.

12/2005 – 02/2010

Lead Engineer, Quality Assurance

VeriSign, Bangalore, India

- Led a QA team for telecom value-added services; built Selenium/TestNG frameworks; coordinated testing across India and the US; member of the Security Validation team.

11/2004 – 12/2005

Quality Assurance Engineer

bebo Technologies, Chandigarh, India

- Functional, manual and database testing of enterprise business-process workflows.

05/2002 – 10/2004

Software Test Engineer

Perichin InfoServ, Chennai, India

- Functional and database testing of Human Capital Management recruitment-lifecycle workflows.

INDEPENDENT PROJECT

Qualinexus – AI-assisted test automation platform (prototype)

- Takes existing test cases (CSV, Excel, Jira or typed requirements) and turns them into automated tests
- Generates positive, negative, boundary and regression cases and the Playwright scripts
- Runs on Chrome, Firefox and WebKit and reports results per requirement
- Asks for clarification when a requirement is too vague to test
- Self-heals when the UI changes: finds the new locator, reruns the test and waits for human approval before applying the fix
- Generates schema-validated test data

- Early prototype demonstrated on a sample store with synthetic data; no customers yet

SKILLS

Leadership & delivery

Engineering management · Team leadership (up to 14 reports) · Project & program delivery · Agile / Kanban · Stakeholder reporting · Risk & escalation management · Jira (15 yrs) · SAP Cloud ALM (3 yrs)

Test automation

Playwright – Python, Robot Framework, TypeScript, POM (2 yrs) · Selenium (5) · Cypress (1) · Robot Framework (2) · TestNG (5) · Tosca (2) · Salesforce test automation · Self-healing automation · Sauce Labs mobile testing

AI-assisted engineering

LLM-assisted test authoring & debugging · RAG, MCP / tool-calling (prototype) · GitHub Copilot · Codex · Windsurf · AI-assisted validation

APIs, data & performance

REST / OData (5) · Postman (5) · JMeter (3) · SQL (10) · Test data management (Pandas, Pydantic)

Languages & DevOps

Python (5) · Java (5) · TypeScript (1) · Jenkins (5) · GitHub Actions (1) · Docker (1) · Kubernetes (1)

Enterprise platforms

SAP S/4HANA (6) · Fiori / UI5 (6) · SuccessFactors · Salesforce · Telecom OSS/BSS · Cybersecurity SaaS · IoT

Numbers in brackets are years of hands-on use.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree, Computer Science
Bharathidasan University, Tiruchirappalli, India · 2000 – 2002

LANGUAGES

English (C1) · Tamil (native) · German (A1, learning)

References available on request. Last updated November 2026.